

**MALTA**

Capital city: Valletta
Area: 122 sq miles (316 sq km)
Population: 394,000
Official languages: Maltese and English
Major religion: Christian 98% Other 2%
Government: Multi-party democracy
Currency: Euro
Adult literacy rate: 93%
Life expectancy: 78 years
People per doctor: 345
Televisions: 735 per 1,000 people

VATICAN CITY

Capital city: Vatican City
Area: 0.17 sq miles (0.44 sq km)
Population: 911
Official languages: Italian and Latin
Major religion: Christian 100%
Government: Ruled by the Pope
Currency: Euro
Adult literacy rate: 80%
Life expectancy: 66 years

SAN MARINO

Capital city: San Marino
Area: 24 sq miles (61 sq km)
Population: 28,119
Official language: Italian
Major religions: Christian 93%, other 7%
Government: Multi-party democracy
Currency: Euro
Adult literacy rate: 99%
Life expectancy: 81 years

MALTA

DUE TO ITS STRATEGIC POSITION on Mediterranean shipping routes, Malta has been ruled by many powers over the centuries. It finally became an independent country in 1964. Perhaps because of this history, the Maltese people cling to a strong sense of national identity, mostly following Roman Catholicism and speaking their own language. The country consists of two main islands, Malta and Gozo, and a smaller island called Comino.

SHIPPING

The busy Grand Harbor of Malta's capital, Valletta, is a sign of how vital shipping is to the Maltese economy. This has been true for centuries due to Malta's position on the trade route between Europe and Africa. Many ships still come here to use the port and facilities for ship refitting.

**TOURISM**

A major source of Malta's income is provided by tourism. Visitors are drawn by its sheltered beaches and coves and its good climate. Another attraction is the country's imposing architecture, a legacy of its history as part of the Roman and Byzantine empires, and later as a British colony. Because of poor soil, farming produces little income. However, light industry, such as clothes manufacturing, is growing in importance.



VATICAN CITY

THE WORLD'S SMALLEST independent state, Vatican City lies at the heart of Rome. This tiny state is the centre of the Roman Catholic Church and the home of the Pope. States ruled by the Pope once stretched right across Italy, and the Vatican is the last survivor. Many visitors are drawn by its religious significance and also its rich cultural legacy. The Vatican has its own flag, national anthem, and stamps, as well as a newspaper and radio station.



This spectacular view is from St. Peter's Basilica. The Pope delivers his messages and blessings to packed crowds in this grand piazza.

SAN MARINO

SITUATED IN ITALY'S MOUNTAINOUS NORTH, San Marino is Europe's smallest republic. It is also one of the oldest, possibly founded around AD 900. During the Middle Ages Italy was divided into powerful "city-states," such as Venice and Florence. These states gradually became absorbed into other, larger territories, but San Marino held on to its independence. The country consists of the capital, also called San Marino, and eight villages. The landscape is dominated by the three peaks of Mount Titano.

**TOURISM**

The fairy-tale fortress of Rocca Tower, perched high on a rocky outcrop, overlooks San Marino. With few resources, the republic relies heavily on a thriving tourist industry.

Find out more

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 SMALL EUROPEAN STATES: 80–81